

WHAT IS ROMA?

ROMA is a performance management framework used by Community Action Agencies to connect program activities to meaningful outcomes for the people they serve. It ensures that every service delivered is tracked, measured, and tied to a larger community impact goal.

THE SIX PHASES OF THE ROMA CYCLE

1	Needs Assessment	Identify the conditions and challenges affecting the community.
2	Planning	Develop strategies and set measurable goals based on identified needs.
3	Resource Development	Secure and align the funding, staff, and partnerships needed.
4	Program Implementation	Deliver services and programs according to the plan.
5	Performance Measurement	Track inputs, outputs, and outcomes to evaluate effectiveness.
6	Reporting & Improvement	Share results with stakeholders and use data to improve services.

KEY PERFORMANCE TERMS

Inputs	Resources used to operate a program (funding, staff, time, materials).
Outputs	The measurable activities and services delivered (e.g., number of clients served).
Outcomes	The changes experienced by individuals as a result of the program.
Impact	Broader community-level change resulting from sustained outcomes.
NPIs	National Performance Indicators. Standardized measures used across all CAAs to report results.

ROMA IN YOUR DAILY WORK

- Document every client interaction accurately and on time.
- Understand how your role connects to at least one NPI.
- Use intake and exit data to tell the full story of client progress.
- Participate in program reviews and bring data-informed observations.
- Ask: What changed for this client because of what we did?

"Without data, you're just another person with an opinion." ~ W. Edwards Deming